

Activity 2 - My Reflection

REFLECT	
Questions	- On a scale of 1(super easy) to 10 (super hard), how would you rate the difficulty of this exercise? - What was the most challenging part? - What was the least challenging part? Re-watch the Luxo Jr. animation video and answer the following: - How closely did you come to re-creating the animation? - What differences do you notice between the Luxo Jr. reference and your animation? - What is your animation missing? - What was the most useful skill you learned or practiced doing this? - If you do this again, what would you do differently? - How will you apply this type of workflow for your GDW game project?

For scaling 1-10, I'd rate this activity a 10 for very difficult. The most challenging part is the timing. It is particularly difficult to replicate the animation on a time chart so that the timing is immaculate. There is also mapping out where the primary, secondary, and tertiary motions, so that it matches/is close enough to the original animation. The least challenging part is definitely the pose, positions of Luxo as it is already rigged.

Upon a rewatch, I feel like I'm not that close and it's just barely matching the original animation. My Luxo's jumping timing is too inconsistent, as well as not having a head turn/look around at the end (I had too much trouble moving it as wildly as the original animation did), I was a bit saddened that I couldn't replicate it as close as I thought I could. There is also an "effect" that makes my character feel like they're floating per jump (jumping in low gravity) which made me think about shifting the frames a bit, but that would ruin the timeline I've made, which was a bit disappointing to me.

Some useful skills I learnt are several hotkeys that allow me to do this faster (i to insert frames, shift d to duplicate a frame, ctrl g to move to selected frame). There was also importing the project into Unity and animate it, which greatly surprises me on how fast and easy it is!

If I could do something differently, it'd be trying to shift the frame closer to whether to get rid of the "floaty" effects. I could maybe find some tutorial on how to do this since the "floaty" effect, I find, is very prevalent against new animators like me.

My GDW project would greatly benefit from some nice and polished animation from this activity. However, I'd prefer to take things slow and practice as I am still new to this. I could approach this by making a rough draft of my animation with major keypoints, animate in Blender and record/note down what works best in terms of animation flows, and repeat from there to the next keypoint.